Sources: https://www.songfacts.com/ https://www.billboard.com/

Song 1: https://youtu.be/4Gj6V59abDA?si=80w6XeHtR-8hUqOx

Why?: Frontman M. Shadows from an interview, "The song is about the game. There's a full backstory to what [the makers of Call of Duty] have been doing for years with their 'Zombies' series. I'm a big fan of the game, I play it all the time, so I got caught up in the story. They sent me over the full storyline, so I made sure it was going along the lines of the zombie story. So that's what it's about." The song was made in four days for the song to make a debut exclusively in Call of Duty: Zombies (Black Ops 1) that Treyarch commissioned. It became memorable to the Zombies Community when it was found.

Song 2: https://youtu.be/L8tb7ffIsyg?si=9vLTLdmbroPKUfqK

Why?: If you've ever been to a professional hockey game, you'll immediately recognize Zombie Nation's career-defining hit "Kernkraft 4000." What you may not know while you're chanting the song's chorus is that it's actually sampling "Stardust," a cut from 1984 computer game Lazy Jones. Zombie Nation heard the melody and reworked it into his song. When the song ahit the Hot 100 at No. 99 for a week in September 2000, Zombie nation paid the original composer from the game as a thanks for allowing them to use his song.

Song 3: https://youtu.be/9NMa32Sf_L4?si=9ESaWQ31U2NF2cmW

Why? Following the release of his surprise February 2015 mixtape, If You're Reading This It's Too Late — fans picked up on its sample of "Haunted Chase" from Donkey Kong Country 2: Diddy's Kong Quest well before then. It was made by Producers Boi-1da and Syk Sense after hearing the sample from "Haunted Chase" and built the beat around the direct sample. It is widely believed the producers grew up playing the SNES classic, as the game is legendary for its atmospheric soundtrack, making it a favorite for hip-hop producers to flip.

Song 4: https://youtu.be/jzMhcP7ab3k?si=E5D98jUV2DLb51Fn

Why?: Singer-rapper DRAM danced his way through the spring of 2015 thanks to his infectious hit "Cha Cha," which prominently samples "Star Road" from the 1990 release Super Mario World. DRAM stated the song was about a "good time," matching the upbeat, nostalgic vibe of the Mario world. Unfortunately, legal disputes came out, and after hearing a Drake song sounding similar to DRAM's, he had to change it to sound similar to the original to avoid any Nintendo trouble.

Song 5: https://youtu.be/1XZRhrt1Tkg?si=JblEpO5g8Jspw8B_

Why? The film's producers wanted to modernize the iconic 8-bit theme song ("Korobeiniki") to fit the movie's high-energy thriller tone. They commissioned Aespa to perform it because their "hyperpop" and futuristic "cyberpunk" concept aligned perfectly with the movie's retro-tech aesthetic. The lyrics metaphorically describe the movie's plot—a high-stakes legal battle to secure the rights to the game—by using game terms like "blocks of obstacles" and "twisted fantasy."